SEWING PATTERN · INSTRUCTION BOOKLET

Girls Circle

SKIRT

A twirly full circle skirt with a real fly zipper, a flat front waistband with a button and a comfy elastic back. Sizes US 2 to 18.



SIZES	LEVEL	SEAM ALLOWANCE	FORMATS
US 2 – 18 (12 sizes)	Confident beginner	1 cm (3/8 in)	A4 · US Letter · A0

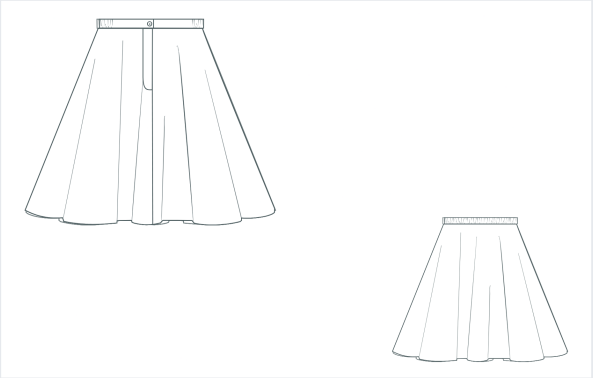
HELPFUL VIDEO GUIDES INCLUDED · CLICKABLE LINKS AND QR CODES ON PAGE 8

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WELCOME

Meet the Girls Circle Skirt

Thank you for choosing this pattern! This full circle skirt spins beautifully and is made to be worn every day. It closes at the front with a real fly zipper and a button, like a pair of jeans, while the elastic in the back of the waistband gives room to grow and keeps it comfortable at school and at play.



Front and back views

Design features

- Full circle skirt: two quarter-circle fronts and a half-circle back
- Front seam with a fly zipper and a fly shield behind it
- Curved topstitched fly, like on jeans
- Waistband flat at the front with 1 button, elastic in the back
- Side seams with matching notches
- Narrow machine hem

What is included

- This illustrated instruction booklet
- Printable pattern files in A4, US Letter and A0, one file per size
- Sizes US 2 to 18 (12 sizes: 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16, 18)
- Helpful video guides with clickable links and QR codes (page 8)

Good to know
The pieces are big because a circle skirt uses a lot of fabric. Lay out all your pieces on the fabric before cutting, and keep the grainline arrows parallel to the selvage.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Get ready to sew

A few minutes of preparation make the whole skirt easier. Tick each point before cutting.

- ☐ **Print the test square**
  Print page 1 at 100 % / Actual size and measure the square: it must be 10 cm (4 in). If not, check your print settings before printing the rest.

- ☐ **Choose your size**
  Choose the size from the child's waist measurement (page 4). If the waist and the height point to different sizes, choose by waist and adjust the length. The elastic back gives a comfortable range (see the finished measurements).

- ☐ **Check the length**
  Each size is drafted for the height in the size chart. To lengthen or shorten, add or remove the same amount all around the hem of the fronts and the back, following the curve.

- ☐ **Transfer every marking**
  Notches, the circle on the front seam, the line marked CUT ON LEFT FRONT and all waistband marks (centre front, side seams, centre back, elastic marks, button and buttonhole).

- ☐ **Allowances**
  Seam allowance 1 cm (3/8 in) is included everywhere. Hem allowance 1 cm (3/8 in), sewn as a narrow 5 mm + 5 mm hem.

- ☐ **Test on a scrap**
  Try your stitch length, the fusible interfacing and a buttonhole on a scrap of your fabric.

- ☐ **The trickiest step**
  The fly zipper (steps 3 to 6). Read the steps once before you start and keep the pictures next to you.

Circle skirt tips
Most of the waist and the hem are on the bias, so they stretch easily. Staystitch the waist edges right after cutting, do not pull the fabric while sewing, and hang the finished skirt for 24 hours before hemming so the bias can drop. Then level the hem if needed. Press each seam as you go.

SIZE CHARTS

Find your size

Measure the child over light clothing, with the tape snug but not tight. Choose the size by the waist.

Body measurements (cm)

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Height	91.4	99.1	106.7	114.3	120.7	127	132	144.8	157.8	162	163.8	165
Chest	53.3	54.6	56.5	58.4	60.3	58.5	63.8	70	75	78.8	82.8	85.2
Waist	48.9	50.5	52.1	54	55.9	52.8	56	59.2	62.2	64	66.2	68
Hips	52.7	54.6	57.5	60.3	63.2	62.8	67.5	75	80.2	85	90.2	92.8

Body measurements (in)

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Height	36	39	42	45	47 1/2	50	52	57	62 1/8	63 3/4	64 1/2	65
Chest	21	21 1/2	22 1/4	23	23 3/4	23	25 1/8	27 1/2	29 1/2	31	32 5/8	33 5/8
Waist	19 1/4	19 7/8	20 1/2	21 1/4	22	20 3/4	22	23 3/8	24 1/2	25 1/4	26 1/8	26 3/4
Hips	20 3/4	21 1/2	22 5/8	23 3/4	24 7/8	24 3/4	26 5/8	29 1/2	31 5/8	33 1/2	35 1/2	36 1/2

Finished skirt measurements (cm)

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Waist, open flat	57	58.8	60.6	62.8	64.9	61.4	65	68.7	72.1	74	76.6	78.5
Waist, elastic relaxed	43.6	45	46.3	47.9	49.5	46.9	49.6	52.3	54.8	56.2	58.1	59.6
Skirt length*	31.9	34.5	37.1	40.1	42.9	45.6	47.7	52.1	56.7	58	58.9	59.4
Hem width	240	258	276	296	314	327	344	375	407	418	426	431

Finished skirt measurements (in)

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Waist, open flat	22 1/2	23 1/8	23 7/8	24 3/4	25 1/2	24 1/8	25 5/8	27	28 3/8	29 1/8	30 1/8	30 7/8
Waist, elastic relaxed	17 1/8	17 3/4	18 1/4	18 7/8	19 1/2	18 1/2	19 1/2	20 5/8	21 5/8	22 1/8	22 7/8	23 1/2
Skirt length*	12 1/2	13 5/8	14 5/8	15 3/4	16 7/8	18	18 3/4	20 1/2	22 1/4	22 7/8	23 1/8	23 3/8
Hem width	94 3/8	101 1/2	108 5/8	116 1/2	123 1/2	128 3/4	135 1/2	147 3/4	160 3/8	164 1/2	167 5/8	169 5/8

*Skirt length is measured at the side, from the top of the waistband to the hem. The waist fits anywhere between "elastic relaxed" and "open flat": the elastic in the back stretches to fit. Hem width is the full circumference of the hem.

FABRIC & NOTIONS

What you need

Suggested fabrics

Light to medium-weight woven fabrics with a soft drape, for example cotton poplin, chambray, light denim (4–6 oz), cotton twill, linen or linen blends, viscose twill. Avoid very stiff fabric (the circle will stand out) and stretch fabric (the fly and the waistband need a stable fabric).

Fabric requirements

Sizes	150 cm / 60 in (m)	150 cm / 60 in (yd)	115 cm / 45 in (m)	115 cm / 45 in (yd)
2–6	1.2 m	1 3/8 yd	1.2 m	1 3/8 yd
7–10	1.4 m	1 5/8 yd	2.9 m	3 1/4 yd
12–18	1.7 m	1 7/8 yd	3.2 m	3 1/2 yd

Estimated by laying out all pieces for the largest size of each group, single layer, pieces turned only 180°, + 8 % for shrinkage and matching. Wash and dry your fabric before cutting. Fusible interfacing: 0.2 m (1/4 yd), any width.

Notions

- Fly zipper (metal or nylon jeans zipper), length in the table below: a longer zipper is fine, you shorten it in step 2
- 1 button, 1 cm (3/8 in)
- Woven or knitted elastic for the back waistband (width and length below)
- Light fusible interfacing
- Matching thread, safety pin

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Zipper	16 cm	16 cm	16 cm	16 cm	16 cm	18 cm	18 cm	18 cm	18 cm	18 cm	18 cm	18 cm
Elastic width	2.5 cm	2.5 cm	2.5 cm	2.5 cm	3 cm	3 cm	3 cm	3 cm	3 cm	3 cm	3 cm	3 cm
Elastic to cut	27	27.9	28.9	30	31.1	29.2	31.1	33	34.8	35.8	37.1	38.1

Elastic to cut (cm) = the elastic length printed on the waistband piece + 2 cm (1 cm at each end to stitch it down).

Printing & assembling

- A4 and US Letter: print at 100 %. Each tile is labelled "row/column" (1/1, 1/2…). Tiles with the same first number form one row: trim one edge, overlap, match the crosses and tape.
- A0: send the file to a copy shop and ask for a print at 100 % scale.

PATTERN PIECES & CUTTING

Cut your pieces

The skirt has 6 pieces. Check that you have them all before you start cutting.

#	Pattern piece	Cut from	Cut
1	Skirt Front	Main fabric	2 (one left, one right, mirrored)
2	Skirt Back	Main fabric	1 (single layer)
3	Waistband	Main fabric	1
4	Fly Facing (fly shield)	Main fabric	1
5	Fly Interfacing	Fusible interfacing	1
6	Waistband Interfacing	Fusible interfacing	2

Cutting tips

- Skirt Front (1): fold the fabric right sides together and cut two fronts at the same time, so you get a left and a right front. Both are cut with the extension at the front edge.
- Left front only: cut away the outer part of the extension along the line marked CUT ON LEFT FRONT. The left front keeps a narrow extension (zipper side), the right front keeps the full, wider extension (this becomes the fly). "Left" and "right" are as worn.
- Skirt Back (2): the piece is drawn whole, with the centre back line in the middle. Cut it on a single layer of fabric, right side up. Do not cut it on the fold.
- Interfacing: Fly Interfacing (5) goes on the wrong side of the right front extension; the two Waistband Interfacings (6) go on the wrong side of each end of the waistband.
- Cut notches outwards, then mark the circle on the front seam and all waistband marks with chalk or a removable pen.

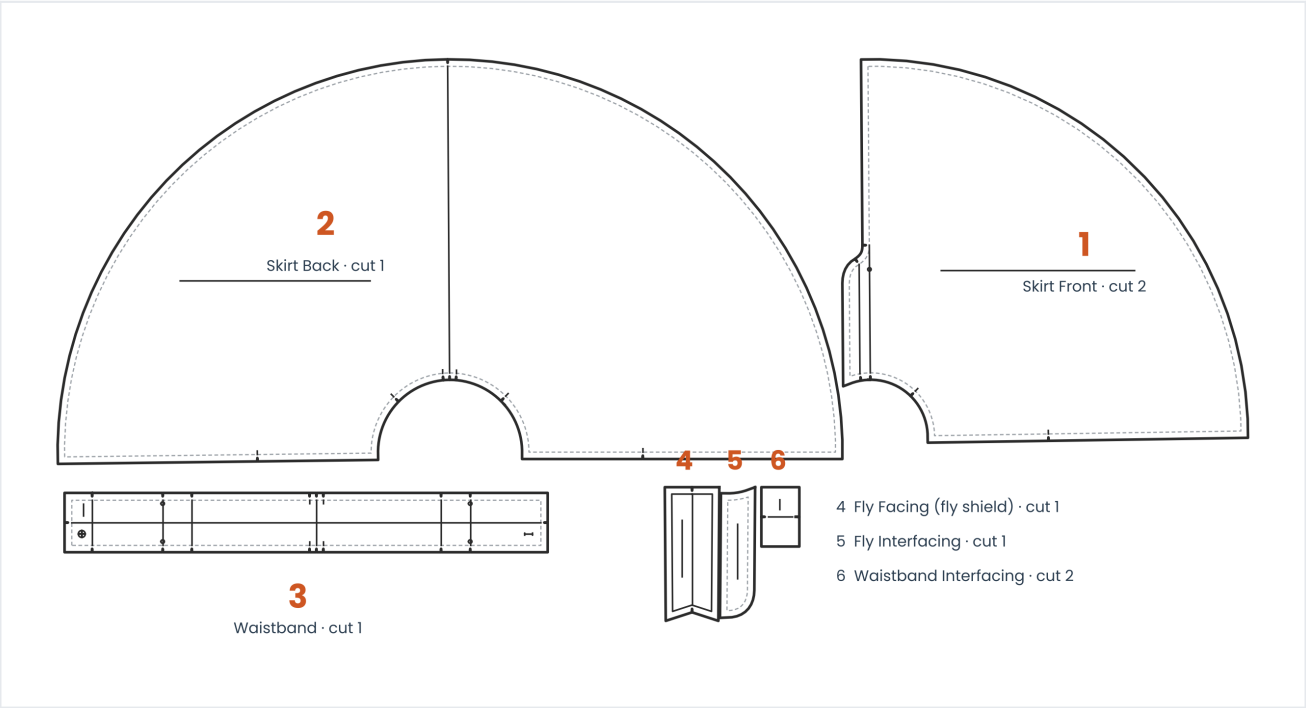
Sewing order at a glance

1 · Prepare	2 · Shorten zipper	3 · Front seam	4 · Zipper
5 · Fly topstitching	6 · Fly shield	7 · Side seams	8 · Waistband + elastic
9 · Attach waistband	10 · Secure elastic	11 · Buttonhole	12 · Hem

PIECES & MARKINGS

Read the pattern

All pieces of size 8, as they look on the printed pattern (not to scale).



Solid thick line	Cutting line.
Grey dashed line	Stitching line, 1 cm (3/8 in) inside the cutting line.
Notches	Small lines on the edge: match them when you pin two pieces together (side seams, waist, waistband).
Circle on the front seam	End of the zipper opening: the front seam is stitched from the hem up to this circle.
Line CUT ON LEFT FRONT	Cut the extension of the left front only along this line.
Arrow	Grainline: place it parallel to the selvage.
Waistband lines	CENTER FRONT (both ends), SIDE SEAM (2), BACK CENTER and the long FOLD line in the middle.
ELASTIC marks	Two circles on the waistband: the elastic ends are stitched here. The elastic length is printed between them.
⊕ and I	Button (on the 3 cm underlap end of the waistband) and buttonhole (other end).

HELPFUL VIDEO GUIDES

Watch & learn

Scan a QR code with your phone or click "Watch the video". Each video shows one technique used in this skirt.

Sewing a zipper fly with a fly extension Watch the video Steps 3–6	Fly front zipper, step by step Watch the video Steps 3–6	Half elastic waistband Watch the video Steps 8–10
Half elastic waistband skirt for a little girl Watch the video Steps 8–10	Perfect buttonholes Watch the video Step 11	5 easy ways to hem a circle skirt Watch the video Step 12

Please note
These videos are made by independent creators and may use other patterns. Always follow the measurements, allowances and sewing order of this guide.

SEWING INSTRUCTIONS

Let's sew

Seam allowance is 1 cm (3/8 in) unless written otherwise. Finish raw edges with a serger or a zigzag stitch. "Left" and "right" always mean as worn.

1 Prepare the pieces

All pieces

- Apply the Fly Interfacing (5) to the wrong side of the wide extension of the right front.
- Apply the two Waistband Interfacings (6) to the wrong side of each end of the waistband (button end and buttonhole end).
- Staystitch the waist edge of both fronts and the back, 6 mm (1/4 in) from the edge, so the curved bias edge does not stretch.
- Finish the front edges (centre front and extensions) and the side seam edges of the fronts and the back.

2 Shorten the zipper

Zipper · picture 1

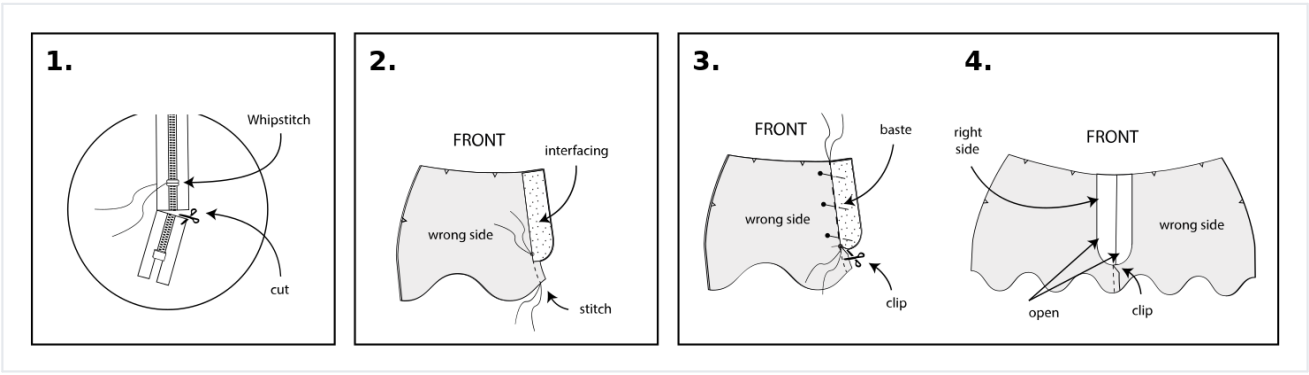
- If your zipper is longer than needed, place it along the front opening with the pull tab 3 mm (1/8 in) below the waist stitching line.
- Mark the new zipper stop at the circle on the front seam. Whipstitch across the teeth at the mark, then cut the zipper 2 cm (3/4 in) below the new stop (picture 1).

3 Sew the front seam

Skirt Front · pictures 2–4

- Place the two fronts right sides together, matching the centre front and the notches.
- Stitch the front seam from the hem up to the circle marking and backstitch (picture 2).
- Baste with long stitches from the circle up to the waist edge along the centre front (picture 3).
- Clip the seam allowance of the left front just below its extension, to the stitching. Press the seam open below the circle (picture 4).

Video help: Sewing a zipper fly with a fly extension



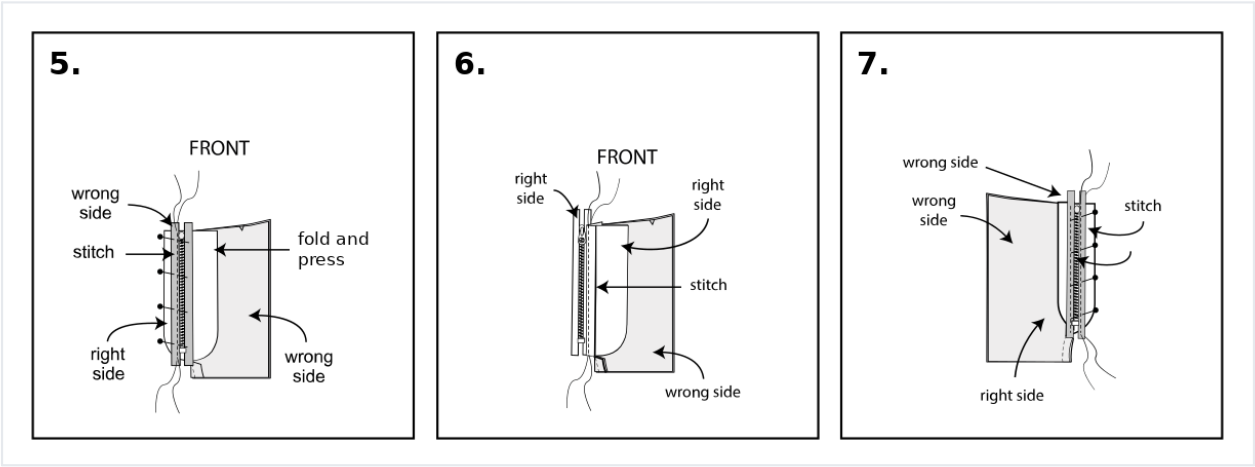
Pictures 1–4. The drawings show the front from the wrong side.

4 Sew in the zipper

Zipper · pictures 5–7

- Fold the narrow extension of the left front in half, wrong sides together, and press.
- Place the zipper face up under this fold, with the coils right next to the folded edge and the top of the zipper at the waist. Pin and stitch 3 mm (1/8 in) from the fold, through the zipper tape and the extension only (picture 5).
- Turn the zipper right side up and topstitch close to the fold, keeping the rest of the skirt out of the stitching (picture 6).
- Lay the skirt flat, wrong side up. Flip the zipper over onto the wide extension of the right front. Pin and stitch the other zipper tape to this extension only, 3 mm (1/8 in) from the coils (picture 7).

Video help: Fly front zipper, step by step



Pictures 5–7. Follow the text for the left and right front: the drawings are shown from the wrong side.

5 Topstitch the fly

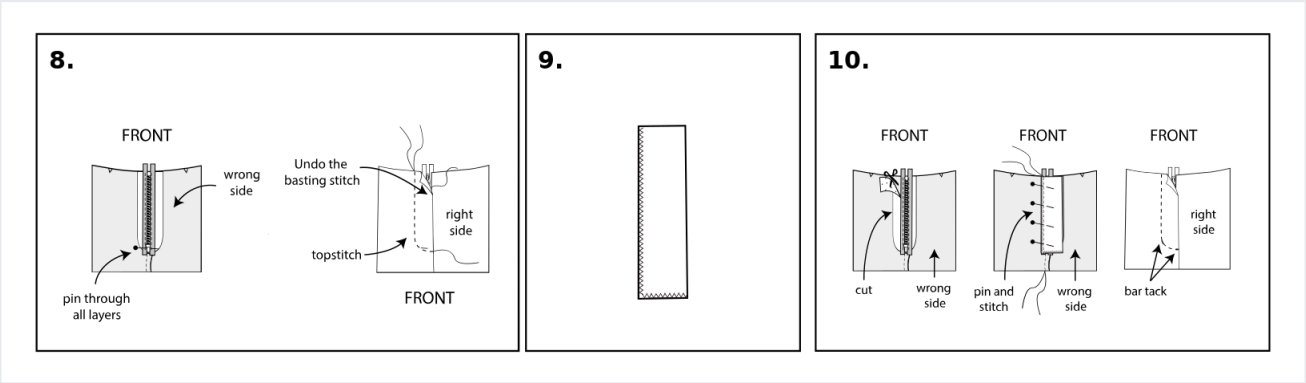
Right Front · picture 8

- On the wrong side, check that the wide extension lies flat under the right front. Pin through all layers just below the zipper stop.
- On the right side, draw the curved fly line with chalk, about 2.5–3 cm (1–1 1/8 in) from the centre front, following the shape of the extension and curving towards the front seam just below the zipper stop.
- Topstitch along the line through the right front and the extension. Make sure the bottom of the curve passes below the zipper stop.
- Remove the basting stitches along the centre front (picture 8).

6 Add the fly shield

Fly Facing · pictures 9–10

- Fold the Fly Facing (4) in half lengthwise, wrong sides together, and zigzag the raw edges together (picture 9).
- On the wrong side, trim any excess of the left extension along the zipper tape. Pin the fly shield behind the zipper on the left side, raw edges along the zipper tape, top edge at the waist.
- Stitch through the fly shield, the zipper tape and the left extension, keeping the skirt free.
- From the right side, bar tack (a short, tight zigzag) at the bottom of the fly curve through all layers, to hold the fly shield in place (picture 10).

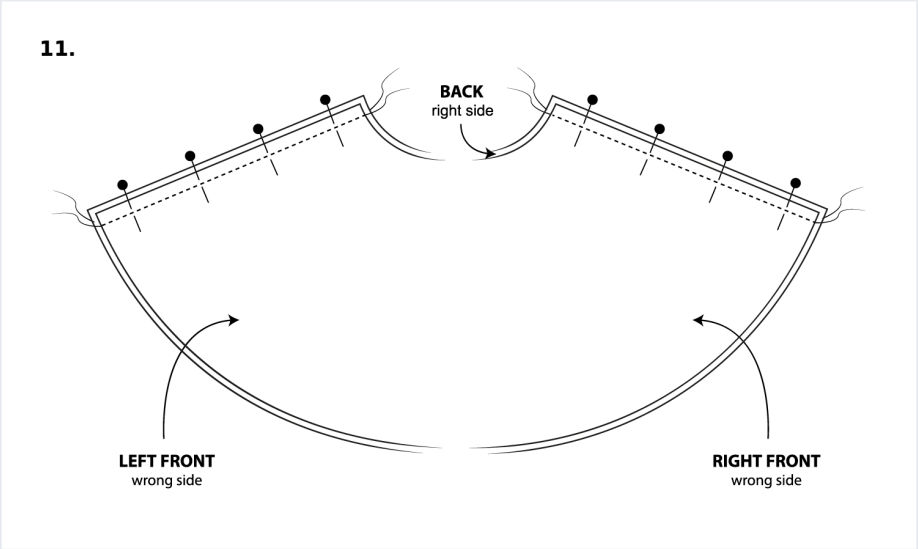


Pictures 8–10.

7 Sew the side seams

Skirt Front + Back · picture 11

- Pin the fronts to the back at the sides, right sides together, matching the notches.
- Stitch the side seams from the waist down to the hem. Do not stretch the fabric.
- Press the seam allowances towards the back.



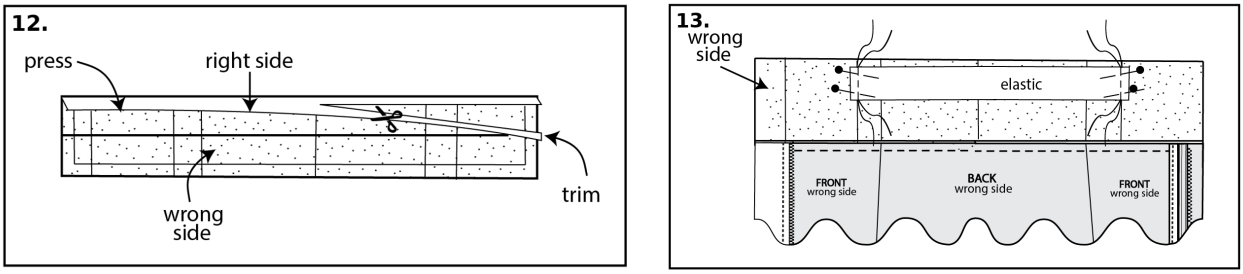
Picture 11.

8 Prepare the waistband

Waistband · pictures 12–13

- Press under the seam allowance on one long edge of the waistband (the edge that will be inside) and trim it to 1 cm (3/8 in) if needed (picture 12).
- Cut the elastic (see page 5). On the wrong side of the waistband, place it on the half that will be inside, next to the fold line, between the two ELASTIC marks.
- Stitch one end of the elastic at the first ELASTIC mark, stretch the elastic to reach the second mark and stitch the other end securely (picture 13). The back of the band gathers when you let go.

Video help: Half elastic waistband

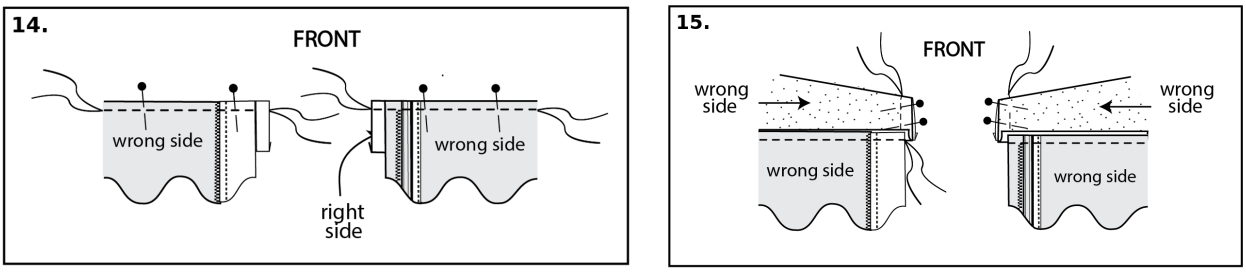


Pictures 12–13.

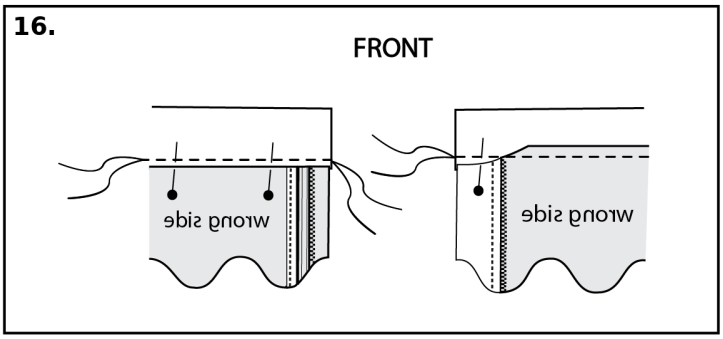
9 Attach the waistband

Waistband · pictures 14–16

- Pin the unpressed edge of the waistband to the waist of the skirt, right sides together. Match the SIDE SEAM marks to the side seams and the BACK CENTER mark to the centre back.
- The end with the 3 cm underlap and the button mark goes on the left front: its CENTER FRONT line matches the left front edge. The other end (buttonhole) is flush with the folded edge of the fly on the right front.
- Stretch the elastic section flat while you stitch. Trim the seam allowance to 6 mm (1/4 in) and press it towards the waistband (picture 14).
- Fold the waistband along the fold line, right sides together. Stitch both short ends and the bottom of the underlap, then trim (picture 15).
- Turn the waistband right side out and press. Pin the pressed edge over the seam on the inside and slipstitch it in place, or topstitch from the right side (picture 16).



Pictures 14–15.



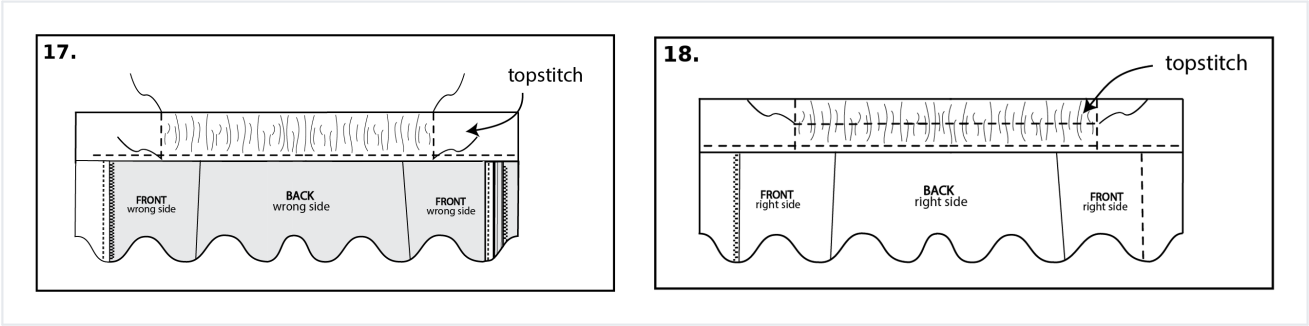
Picture 16.

10 Secure the elastic

Waistband · pictures 17–18

- Stitch through all layers at the two ends of the elastic section (on the ELASTIC marks) so the elastic cannot move (picture 17).
- Stretch the back waistband flat and topstitch through all layers along the elastic section, close to the bottom edge of the band. A second row near the top edge is optional (picture 18).

Video help: Half elastic waistband skirt for a little girl



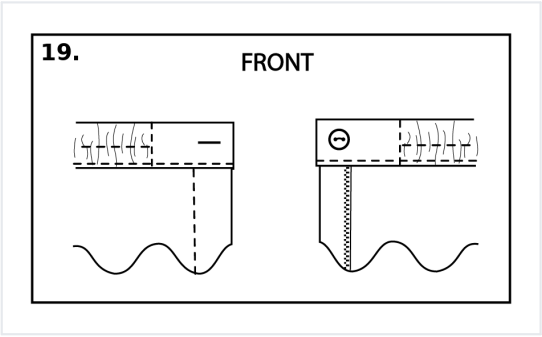
Pictures 17–18.

11 Buttonhole and button

Waistband · picture 19

- Make a horizontal buttonhole 1.2 cm (1/2 in) long at the buttonhole mark on the right end of the waistband.
- Close the zipper, lap the right end over the underlap and mark the button position through the buttonhole. Sew the 1 cm (3/8 in) button on the underlap (picture 19).

Video help: Perfect buttonholes



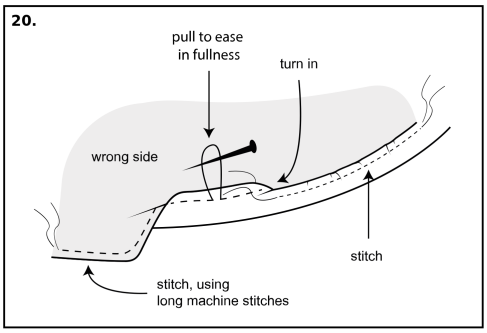
Picture 19.

12 Hem the skirt

Hem · picture 20

- Hang the skirt for 24 hours so the bias parts can drop, then try it on and level the hem if needed.
- Stitch 5 mm (1/4 in) from the lower edge with a long stitch. Turn the edge up along this stitching and press, pulling the thread a little where the curve needs easing.
- Turn up again 5 mm (1/4 in) to enclose the raw edge, pin and stitch close to the inner fold. Press (picture 20).

Video help: 5 easy ways to hem a circle skirt



Picture 20.

FINISHED!

Enjoy your Girls Circle Skirt

Well done! Give the skirt a final press and let her twirl.



Styling ideas

- With a tucked-in tee or a fitted long-sleeve top
- With tights and boots in winter
- With a cardigan for a party look

Care

- Wash at 30 °C, inside out, with the zipper closed
- Do not tumble dry hot (elastic)
- Press on the wrong side

Need help?
If a step is unclear, message us through our Etsy shop BenchGoods – we are happy to help.

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